

Burak Kalafat

Senior Backend Engineer | .NET & Technical Leadership

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Istanbul, Turkey | Europe/Istanbul

Summary

Senior backend engineer with nearly 14 years of software engineering experience across banking, financial services, and enterprise applications. Specializes in C#/.NET backend services and legacy modernization, including COBOL/mainframe and .NET Framework migrations. Provides architecture guidance, code-review ownership, and mentoring, with international remote experience. Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate.

Technical Skills

Backend Engineering: C#, .NET, .NET Core, ASP.NET MVC, REST APIs, EF Core, Asynchronous programming, WCF

Architecture and Design: Clean Architecture, Legacy modernization, Service-oriented architecture, Repository, Unit of Work, Facade, Strategy

Databases: SQL Server (MSSQL), Oracle, PL/SQL

Languages and Frameworks: Java, Spring, TypeScript, JavaScript, WPF, WinForms, Knockout.js

DevOps: Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, CI/CD

AI-Assisted Development: GitHub Copilot Enterprise, Prompt engineering, Spec-Driven Development (SDD)

Quality and Leadership: Unit testing, Playwright E2E testing, Code reviews, Mentoring, Architecture guidance, Coding standards

Training: Microservices, Distributed systems, .NET with AWS, Containerization, React

Professional Experience

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | Innovance

May 2024 – Present | Istanbul, Turkey (Remote)

- Led COBOL/mainframe modernization for Akbank, translating legacy banking functionality into C# and Java backend services.
- Guided backend design and coding standards using Clean Architecture; mentored developers on maintainable implementation patterns.
- Applied specification-driven workflows with GitHub Copilot Enterprise to align generated code with implementation requirements.
- Built internet and mobile banking backends for Türkiye Finans with ASP.NET MVC, WCF, SQL Server, and unit tests.

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | insightsoftware

September 2022 – April 2024 | North Carolina, USA (Remote)

- Contributed to backend architecture and technical design for .NET Core features.
- Developed C# backend features for enterprise financial software.
- Collaborated with an international remote team on backend design and delivery.

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | OBSS

September 2017 – September 2022 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Led Halkbank's mobile banking backend migration from .NET Framework to .NET Core and Clean Architecture.
- Applied asynchronous programming and thread optimization to the mobile banking backend's request handling.
- Built REST APIs with EF Core and SQL Server; used Repository/Unit of Work patterns and Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines.
- Owned code reviews and mentored Türkiye Finans developers; established coding standards for WinForms and WCF customer applications.
- Led full-stack payment campaign development for Akbank using C#, Java/Spring, TypeScript, Knockout.js, and Oracle 12c.

Java Developer | TÜBİTAK

January 2017 – September 2017 | Kocaeli, Turkey

- Built Java software to write EAC/SAC security data to passport smartcard chips using APDU commands for government identification systems.

.NET Developer | VakıfBank

August 2013 – January 2017 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Modernized VakıfBank CRM and collections applications toward service-oriented architecture with WPF/MVVM, WCF, Oracle 11g, and PL/SQL.

Part-Time .NET Developer | VeriPark

December 2012 – June 2013 | Izmir, Turkey

- Built ASP.NET widgets for Turkcell's SharePoint environment while completing the Computer Engineering degree.

Education

BSc in Computer Engineering

Ege University, Izmir, Turkey | September 2008 – June 2013

Certifications

Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate

Microsoft | Certification | March 6, 2026 | Expires March 6, 2027 | Certification overview (AI-102)

Introduction to GitHub Copilot

Microsoft Learn | Training | 2024 | Course overview

Build Microservices with .NET and Amazon Web Services

Udemy | Training | February 2024

IELTS - Band 7

British Council | Language test | 2023

React Nanodegree Program

Udacity | Training | February 2020

Languages

Turkish: Native; English: Professional proficiency; IELTS Band 7 (2023)

Interests

Chess; LLM and RAG applications; AI-powered customer service; Travel and cultural exchange